

3-Ingredient Guava & Cream Cheese Bites

These buttery, flaky puff pastry bites draw inspiration from pastelillos, a Puerto Rican pastry. We fill these bites with guava paste and cream cheese for a bite-size appetizer that couldn't be easier to make. Using frozen puff pastry keeps prep simple while ensuring light, golden layers that bake up beautifully in the oven. These three-ingredient sweet-and-savory bites are ideal for holiday gatherings.

By **Amanda Holstein** | Published on November 10, 2025

 Reviewed by Dietitian **Emily Lachtrupp, M.S., RD**

Active Time: 10 mins

Total Time: 45 mins

Servings: 24

Nutrition Profile:

Sesame-Free Low-Carb Nut-Free Low-Sodium Vegetarian Egg-Free Low-Calorie

Ingredients

1 (17.3-ounce) package frozen puff pastry sheets, thawed

1 (8-ounce) package cream cheese

¼ cup guava paste (about 2 ounces)

Directions

Step 1

Preheat oven to 400°F. Lightly coat a 24-cup mini muffin tin with cooking spray.

Step 2

Unfold puff pastry sheets on a clean work surface. Cut each sheet into 12 rectangles (3-by-2¼-inch). Press 1 rectangle into each prepared muffin cup. Spoon about 1½ teaspoons cream cheese into each cup. Top each with ½ teaspoon guava paste.

Step 3

Bake until the pastry is golden brown and cooked through, 25 to 27 minutes. Let cool in the pan for 10 minutes before serving warm or at room temperature.

To make ahead

Assemble bites and refrigerate, covered, for up to 1 day before baking.

Equipment

24-cup mini muffin tin

Frequently Asked Questions

What is guava paste and where can I find it?

Guava paste is a thick paste made by cooking down guava fruit with sugar until it forms a dense, jelly-like block. Look for it in the international or Latin foods aisle at a grocery store, at Latin American or Caribbean markets or online.

What can I use in place of guava paste?

While the texture and flavor will differ, quince paste, fig jam or apricot preserves can stand in for the guava paste.

Can I freeze these bites?

Yes! The baked bites can be cooled, wrapped and frozen for up to 3 months.

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Nutrition Facts

Per serving: **Serving Size 1 bite** 148 calories; total fat 11g; saturated fat 3g; cholesterol 10mg; sodium 81mg; total carbohydrate 10g; dietary fiber 0g; total sugars 1g; added sugars 1g; protein 2g; vitamin c 4mg; calcium 12mg; iron 1mg; potassium 32mg

Additional reporting by Hilary Meyer and Mandy Enright, M.S., RDN, RYT

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